Freight Dispatch & Carrier Onboarding Guide

Standard Operating Procedures, Onboarding Requirements, Equipment Specifications, and Payment Structures

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1. Symmetry Conversation & Onboarding Workflow

Core Conversation & Qualification Steps

1. **Greeting:** Establish professional rapport and introduce dispatch services.
2. **Type of Truck:** Determine equipment classification (Box Truck, Hot Shot, Semi Truck/Power Only, Dry Van, Reefer, Flatbed, Step Deck).
3. **Accessories of Truck:** Verify availability of loading/securing gear (Lift Gate, Pallet Jack, Straps, Tarps, Chains, Binders).
4. **Motor Carrier (MC) Authority Check:**
    - Request and verify MC Number.
    - **Age Requirement:** Target MC age is ideally **4–5 months** old minimum.
    - **Insurance Verification (If No MC / New MC):**
        - **Non-Trucking Liability**
        - **Automobile Coverage:** $750,000 to $1,000,000 auto liability coverage.
        - **Cargo Coverage:** $100,000 cargo insurance coverage.
        - *Note:* Ask carrier to add cargo coverage if auto liability is active but cargo is missing.

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2. Dispatcher Sales Pitch & Commission Negotiation

Case Study / Script Guidelines (e.g., Sales Scenario: "Jose")

- **Situation:** Prospect was previously approached and promised to follow up in 2 days. Sales manager followed up to inquire about current broker rates/charges.
- **Competitor Offer:** Prospect mentions receiving an **8% rate/charge on MC**.
- **Closing / Pitching Strategy:**
    - Convince and close at **10% commission**.
    - **Value Proposition / Earnings Target:** Target consistent gross weekly earnings of $5,000 or more **, or **6,000+ for Over-The-Road (OTR)** setups.

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3. Operational Preferences & Route Setup

- **OTR vs. Local Load:**
    - **OTR (Over The Road):** Long distance, all over the country.
    - **Local Load:** Small miles / local radius.
- **Capacity & Schedule Questions:**
    - *How many miles can you cover in a day?*
    - *How long can you stay on the road?*
    - *Schedule:* **Monday to Friday** is standard and fine.
- **Expectation Management:**
    - Daily home time ("Back home everyday") is **not provided**.
    - Drivers sleep in the vehicle/truck at night during the workweek.
    - Focus is placed on securing the most **profitable loads** during OTR runs.

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4. Onboarding Process & Document Checklist

Onboarding Timeline & Workflow

1. Inquire: *"When would you like to start working?"*
2. Explain: Short and streamlined onboarding process.
3. Once all required documents are received, carrier profile is shifted to the **Dispatch Department**, where dispatchers immediately begin searching for and booking loads.

Required Carrier Documents

1. **Driver's License**
2. **Certificate of Insurance (COI):** Listing company address and certificate holder details ($1,000,000 Auto Liability / $100,000 Cargo).
3. **Truck Registration Sheet**
4. **Photos of Truck / Equipment**
5. **Notice of Assignment (NOA):** Required if carrier uses a factoring company.

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5. Equipment Specifications & Accessories

Equipment Dimensions & Weight Capacity

Vehicle / Trailer Type	Length Specifications	Weight Capacity / Payload	Notes & Accessories
Box Truck	24 ft / 26 ft	10,000 lbs – 17,000 lbs	**Accessories:** Lift Gate, Pallet Jack
Hot Shot	30 ft / 40 ft	Varies by setup	**Accessories:** Binders, Straps, Tarps, Chains
Dry Van	48 ft / 53 ft	40,000 lbs – 48,000 lbs	General freight enclosure
Reefer (Refrigerated)	48 ft / 53 ft	40,000 lbs – 48,000 lbs	Temperature control (Cold / Hot)
Flatbed	48 ft / 53 ft	40,000 lbs – 48,000 lbs (Up to 100,000 lbs gross max)	Open deck transport
Step Deck	48 ft / 53 ft	Matches flatbed standard	Lowered deck height
Power Only	N/A	Variable	Tractor unit attached in front of pre-loaded trailers

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6. Payment Models & Financial Structures

A. Dispatcher Pricing Models (Charging the Carrier)

1. **Flat Rate Fee:**
    - **Box Truck:** $250 – $300 fixed fee per week.
    - **Hot Shot:** $250 – $300 fixed fee per week.
    - **Semi Truck / Power Only:** $300 – $350 fixed fee per week.
2. **Percentage / Commission Rate:**
    - **Box Truck & Hot Shot:** 8% to 10% per load.
    - **Semi Trucks / Power Only:** 8% to 10% per load.

B. Broker Payment Methods (How Carriers Get Paid)

1. **Standard Pay:**
    - **Timeline:** 24 to 28 days processing time.

- **Deduction:** 0% fee (Full payment).

2. **Quick Pay:**
    - **Timeline:** 3 to 4 days processing time.
    - **Deduction:** 3% to 4% fee deducted by broker.
    - **Requirement:** Requires submitting a voided check along with rate confirmation and proof of delivery (BOL).
3. **Factoring Company:**
    - **Timeline:** Within 24 hours.
    - **Deduction:** 5% to 6% fee (handled via 3rd party factoring firm).
    - **Requirement: Notice of Assignment (NOA)** must be on file.
4. **Fuel Advances / Cash Advances:**
    - Direct fuel cards are **not provided**.
    - Monetary payment/advance is issued within **24 to 48 hours** to maintain high service standards and carrier satisfaction.